

have given rise to it. In any event, *ημερας ιδειν* is early, independent and in my opinion probably original.

χρονος 4:3 P⁷²ΣABC [26%]

The thirty-eight non-**f**³⁵ MSS listed by *ECM* for this variant include all five early uncials, so there is no question about age. (Just two words later the same five early uncials read *βουλημα* instead of *θελημα*, showing that **f**³⁵ is independent of them.) There will be over twenty independent lines in the 5th century, at least half of which should go back to the 3rd, or so I imagine. I would render verses 2-3^a like this: “...so as not to live your remaining time in flesh for human lusts any longer, but for the will of God. Because the time that has passed is plenty for you to have performed the will of the Gentiles...” The phrase ‘of life’ gets in the way. **f**³⁵ is early and independent; I consider that its reading here is most probably original.

αιωνας 4:11 P⁷² [27%]

The thirty-one non-**f**³⁵ MSS listed by *ECM* for this variant include P⁷², so there is no question about age. They will reduce to about twenty independent lines in the 5th century, at least half of which should go back to the 3rd, or so I imagine. That the familiar *των αιωνων* should be added, if the original lacked it, is predictable; that it should be omitted is harder to explain. I would render, “throughout the ages”. **f**³⁵ is early and independent; I consider that its reading here is most probably original.

σθενωσαι θεμελιωσαι 5:10 [30%]

The twenty-four non-**f**³⁵ MSS listed by *ECM* for this variant will reduce to no less than twelve independent lines of transmission in the fifth century, aside from **f**³⁵, at least half of which should go back to the 3rd, or so I imagine. Is Peter affirming that God will, future indicative, or asking that God may, aorist optative? How does “after you have suffered a while” affect the equation? Again I will stick with **f**³⁵. This reading is certainly ancient and in my opinion is most probably original.

Conclusion

Obviously the picture we have seen so far will be true for all other **f**³⁵ minority readings, as we move up to 35%, 40%, etc. As in James, **f**³⁵ is clearly early and independent of **K**^x. If it is independent of all other lines of transmission as well, as I believe, then it harks back to the Original—what other reasonable explanation is there?